

Fiery Ram-Don

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FIERY RAM-DON

Ram-don is the dish made famous by the South Korean film *Parasite*. The name comes from the two instant noodle types that are used in the recipe: ramen and udon. Of course, Korean food fans might know the dish by its traditional name, *jjapaguri*. In that popular movie, the typically budget-friendly instant noodle bowl is topped with high-quality beef, which really elevates the experience. We do the same here, but we also kick things up by adding some sesame chili oil, which is why we call this dish "fiery." If you want to eliminate the spice, you can swap in regular sesame oil instead.

Serves 4

In a medium bowl, stir together the steak, salt and ponzu sauce. Cover the bowl and set aside to marinate for 30 minutes.

12 oz (340 g) sirloin or ribeye steak, cut to $\frac{3}{4}$ -inch (2-cm) dice

$\frac{1}{2}$ tbsp (6 g) kosher salt

2½ tbsp (38 ml) ponzu sauce

2 tsp (10 ml) vegetable oil

2 (4.5-oz [127-g]) packages chapagetti

2 (4.2-oz [120-g]) packages neoguri

2 scallions, thinly sliced, for garnish

Sesame chili oil or regular same oil to taste, for garnish

Place a large skillet over medium-high heat and warm the vegetable oil. When the oil is hot, add the steak (discarding the marinade) in a single layer. Cook, without stirring, until golden brown, about 2 minutes. Flip the steak and continue cooking until medium, about 2 minutes. Transfer to a plate, cover and set aside.

Bring a large pot of water to a boil over high heat. Add all four packages of instant noodles (setting aside all of the seasoning packets for now) and cook, stirring occasionally, for 3 minutes. Scoop out and reserve 2 cups (480 ml) of the noodle water. Drain, but do not rinse, the noodles.

In a large bowl, combine the reserved noodle water and the contents of all of the seasoning packets that came with the four packages of noodles, including any soup bases, vegetables and/or oil. The exact contents of the seasonings may vary from brand to brand; that's okay, just add them all. Whisk together. Add the drained noodles and toss until the noodles are completely coated with the sauce. Add the steak and toss to combine.

Divide among four bowls, and top with the scallions and sesame chili oil.

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